LEFI SHAN

Legal name: Kevin Shan | GAME, LEVEL & TECHNICAL DESIGNER (LEVEL · COMBAT 3C · SYSTEMS)

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Portfolio: leficious.com | Watch 2026 Reel

Game, level, and technical designer creating spatial puzzle layouts, combat 3C, and gameplay prototypes in Unreal Engine 5 and Unity, backed by Maya 3D modeling/rigging, environment production, and Python pipeline tooling.

SELECTED GAME, LEVEL & TECHNICAL DESIGN PROJECTS

Still Life | Play on itch.io | Trailer | GDD | 1-Page Pitch **2026**
Solo Unity prototype | Game & multi-floor level design, Maya 3D modeling/rigging, and AI-assisted C# prototyping
• Designed a 200m, 5-room surrealist puzzle facility centered on a 3-story, 4-stage counterweight atrium where unlocking each animal requires allocating 100% of a 235 kg weight pool across elevators, gap bridges, focus lenses, and gates.
• Modeled and rigged an 18-joint Desk Lamp companion in Maya and directed its 5-state escort behavior, color-coded floor indicator lines, and inverted cold-vent and crusher puzzles to set up a wordless habit-reversal finale.

An Echo Has No Shape | Play on itch.io | Trailer | 5-Page GDD **2026**
Solo 4-week Unity prototype | Level design, 4-scale sightless wayfinding, and AI-assisted C# prototyping
• Designed a continuous 550m x 550m sightless acoustic labyrinth around a single echolocation input (Press E), connecting a central hub and three regional puzzles with zero HUD markers, minimaps, or loading screens via a 4-scale non-UI wayfinding hierarchy.
• Created three regional puzzle rulesets around the same ping input (phantom ice decoys, sequential 3-wing city loops, and 3.0s silence gates), adding a visual wave-clash cue after playtests showed players spamming E so they discover the pause rule.

Fallen Valkyrie **2025**
Solo 10-week UE5 prototype | Combat 3C state machines, directional hit reactions, and multi-phase StateTree Boss AI
• Designed a playable boss stage around unarmed, spear, and bow combat, weapon-dependent lock-on targeting (sphere trace vs. over-the-shoulder aim camera), delayed-regen stamina/mana pacing, and dot-product directional hit reactions.
• Implemented layered upper/lower-body Animation Blueprints, Anim Notify socket collision windows, Motion Warping, Kawaii Physics secondary motion, and reusable StateTree tasks with a mid-fight invulnerable aerial phase.

Starshore **2025**
Solo 15-week UE5 prototype | Dual-mode locomotion 3C, GAS combat, and box-garden exploration
• Built ground and high-speed flight locomotion, dash cancels, and a 5-hit combo; double-tap forward blends into flight and release or interruption transitions smoothly back to ground movement.
• Designed passive spell targeting within a 750-unit, 45-degree camera cone; connected GAS abilities (Attributes, Effects, Tags), physics-impulse loot, inventory, and dynamic grid vendors into one playable loop.

Grid-Based Tactical RPG Template **2026**
Solo UE5 systems prototype | Blueprint and UMG level-authoring tools
• Implemented a snappable tactical grid, A* pathfinding, Dijkstra movement ranges, and path-cost previews alongside a UMG grid-authoring and passability debugging tool with reusable data-driven unit, class, and Animation Blueprint templates.

ADDITIONAL 3D PRODUCTION, TECHNICAL ART & PIPELINE WORK

Stylize Normals Toolkit v3.0 & 3D Environment / Rigging Work **2025-26**
Maya, Python, Maya API, Unreal Engine 5, Houdini | Open-source tool, environment lighting, and character rigging/animation
• Developed an open-source multi-target Maya workflow for generating, transferring, previewing, and repairing custom vertex normals; built stylized UE5 environments (Sacred Forest, Water Blossoms) and Maya IK/FK character rigs and animations.

EDUCATION

University of Southern California | M.S., Game Design and Development | Expected May 2028
Gnomon School of Visual Effects | B.F.A., Digital Production - Games (Featured in Student Reel) | June 2025

TOOLS AND SKILLS

Gameplay & Level Design: Unreal Engine 5, Blueprints, GAS, StateTree, Behavior Trees, Enhanced Input, UMG, Unity, level & puzzle layout, 3C & combat feel, non-UI spatial wayfinding, playtesting, data-driven systems
3D, Animation & Code: Maya (modeling, IK/FK rigging, keyframe animation, Maya API, MEL), Animation Blueprints, state machines, Motion Warping, Anim Notifies, retargeting, ZBrush, Substance 3D, SpeedTree, Gaea, Houdini, Python, C++, C#, Git, Perforce
AI-Assisted Workflows: Antigravity, Codex (AI-assisted scripting & rapid prototyping); Stable Diffusion (ComfyUI, Automatic1111), chaiNNer; Meshy AI, Suno, ElevenLabs